Tomislav Mesarić

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Butcher experienced in high-street and market butchery. Skilled in breaking down beef, pork and lamb carcasses, boning, trimming and portioning meat to order, making fresh sausages, and maintaining clean, safe counters. Experienced in customer advice, FIFO stock rotation, and HACCP temperature checks and records.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Butcher | Mesnica Kod Ante (family butcher shop), Zagreb | 2019–Present

- Break down 2–3 beef forequarters and 10–12 pork sides per week; bone, trim and portion meat for the counter.
- Make four varieties of fresh sausage to the shop's recipes; produce about 40 kg weekly in the busy season.
- Developed the shop's lamb merguez recipe and adjusted the ćevapi mix to 70% beef / 30% lamb in response to customer feedback; ćevapi won 2nd place at the Zagreb County craft meat fair in 2023.
- Rotate cold-room stock every morning using FIFO; record cold-room (0–4 °C) and display-counter temperature checks twice daily.
- Serve about 120 customers on a Saturday, advising on cuts, quantities and cooking times.
- Trained two apprentices in knife handling and cleaning routines.
- Prepare whole lambs and suckling pigs for spit-roasting for three weddings and about 10 family parties a year (2022–2025), managing orders, butchery, seasoning and morning delivery; largest order: four lambs and two pigs for a 180-guest wedding in Samobor (2024).
- Conducted a six-week dry-ageing trial of beef ribs at 21- and 28-day ageing periods, keeping weight-loss and temperature records; the shop now sells about 15 kg monthly by pre-order.

Counter assistant | Tržnica Dolac meat hall stall, Zagreb | 2015–2019

- Served customers, weighed and priced orders, operated the till and completed cash-up.
- Cleaned and sanitised slicers, mincers and the counter at close.
- Wrote a closing and cleaning checklist following a market hygiene inspection remark; it remains in use at the stall.

EDUCATION AND CERTIFICATES

Vocational certificate: Butcher, 3-year programme | Food Trades School Zagreb | 2015
HACCP basic food hygiene certificate | 2021, renewed 2024

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Preparing for the master butcher exam (majstorski ispit) at the Chamber of Trades; exam planned for spring 2027.

SKILLS

Carcass breakdown (beef, pork, lamb) · Boning and trimming · Fresh sausage making · Knife sharpening · Mincer and bandsaw operation · FIFO stock rotation · HACCP knowledge · Cold-chain temperature checks and records · Hygiene and sanitation · Customer service and product advice · Cash handling · Hand pallet jack

LANGUAGES

Croatian (native) · English (good) · German (basic)